

Absolutely. Many of our clients come to us after conventional treatment hasn't fully resolved their pet's issues, or when they want to reduce their pet's reliance on long-term medications. We fully respect and often work alongside conventional veterinary care. We'll review all existing diagnoses, test results, and treatments so we can build a holistic plan that complements — and where possible, improves upon — what your pet is already receiving.

Canine Rehab Appointments Available!

CALL NOW

Herbal Therapy for Dogs & Cats in Fort Lauderdale – Nature's Most Powerful Pet Medicine

Herbal therapy — also called botanical medicine or phytotherapy — is the use of plants and plant-derived substances to prevent, treat, and manage disease in animals. It is one of the oldest forms of medicine on earth, used across virtually every human culture for thousands of years, and the very foundation from which much of modern pharmacology was derived.

In veterinary herbal medicine, carefully selected plants are used in whole or concentrated form to support your pet's organs, immune system, nervous system, digestion, skin, joints, and more. Unlike isolated pharmaceutical compounds, whole plant medicines contain hundreds of synergistic compounds that work together — often more safely and gently than synthetic drugs.

WHAT WE TREAT

Conditions we address with herbal therapy

Herbal medicine can play a meaningful therapeutic role across a wide spectrum of pet health conditions — from everyday wellness support to complex chronic disease management.

Skin & Allergies

- Environmental allergies
- Food sensitivities
- Hot spots & itching
- Seborrhea & dandruff

Organs & Systems

- Liver disease & toxin support
- Kidney disease
- Heart & circulation
- Thyroid imbalance

Joints & Mobility

- Arthritis & stiffness
- Post-surgical recovery
- Hip dysplasia support
- Disc disease support

Mind & Behavior

- Anxiety & stress
- Thunderstorm & noise phobia
- Cognitive dysfunction
- Adrenal & stress disorders

Digestion & Gut

- IBD & colitis
- Nausea & vomiting
- Constipation & diarrhea
- Leaky gut & dysbiosis

Immune & Cancer

- Chronic infections
- Autoimmune disease
- Cancer support & palliation
- Post-chemo recovery

Powerful Herbs We use for Cats and Dogs

Our herbal prescribing draws from Western and Chinese botanical traditions. Here are some of the most commonly used and evidence-supported herbs in our veterinary herbal practice.

ANTI-INFLAMMATORY & PAIN RELIEF

BOSWELLIA · FRANKINCENSE

Boswellia serrata

One of the most well-researched natural anti-inflammatories for pets. Inhibits inflammatory pathways without the GI or kidney side effects of NSAIDs. Excellent for arthritis, joint pain, and inflammatory bowel disease in dogs and cats.

GOLDEN SPICE

Turmeric / Curcumin

Potent anti-inflammatory and antioxidant. Supports joint health, digestive function, liver health, and may have anti-cancer properties. Must be properly formulated for bioavailability in pets — we prescribe the right form and dose.

DEVIL'S CLAW

Harpagophytum procumbens

Traditional African herb with powerful anti-inflammatory and analgesic properties. Particularly effective for musculoskeletal pain, arthritis, and post-surgical recovery in dogs. Not recommended in cats.

WILLOW BARK

Salix alba

Nature's original aspirin. Contains salicylates that reduce pain and inflammation naturally. Used carefully in dogs for musculoskeletal conditions — always dosed precisely and not used in cats.

IMMUNE SYSTEM SUPPORT

ECHINACEA

Echinacea purpurea

One of the most popular immune-stimulating herbs for pets. Supports immune response during infection, respiratory illness, and recovery from illness. Used in short courses rather than continuously for best effect.

ASTRAGALUS

Astragalus membranaceus

A revered adaptogenic herb from Chinese medicine. Supports deep immune function, adrenal health, and overall vitality. Excellent for immunocompromised pets, cancer support, and chronic illness.

MEDICINAL MUSHROOMS

Reishi, Turkey Tail, Shiitake

Powerful immunomodulating fungi with significant research support in veterinary oncology. Turkey Tail in particular has shown remarkable results in extending survival in dogs with certain cancers. Also support gut health and energy.

Important: Herbal safety is different for cats vs. dogs

This is one of the most critical aspects of veterinary herbal medicine — and a major reason why professional guidance matters. Cats are not small dogs. They lack certain

liver enzymes that metabolize many plant compounds, making them far more sensitive to herbal toxicity than dogs.

Common herbs that are **safe and beneficial for dogs** can be **toxic or even fatal for cats** — including tea tree oil, pennyroyal, certain essential oils, and high doses of several medicinal herbs. Even "natural" or "herbal" products from pet stores may not be safe for cats.

This is exactly why you should never give your cat herbal remedies without guidance from a qualified holistic veterinarian. At Healing Paws Center, all of our herbal protocols are species-specific, carefully dosed, and safe for your individual pet.

Herbal therapy for pets – FAQ

Can I just buy herbal supplements from a pet store?

We strongly advise against self-prescribing herbal supplements for your pet without veterinary guidance. The pet supplement industry is largely unregulated — products vary wildly in quality, potency, and accuracy of labeling. More importantly, what's appropriate for one pet may be harmful to another. Species differences (especially cat vs. dog), concurrent medications, organ function, and individual health history all affect which herbs are safe and effective. Please consult us before starting any herbal protocol.

Can herbal therapy be used with my pet's current medications?

Often yes — but this requires careful professional assessment. Some herbs can interact with pharmaceutical drugs: for example, milk thistle may affect how the liver processes certain medications, and St. John's Wort (not commonly used in pets) has significant drug interactions. We review your pet's complete medication list at every consultation and select herbs that are safe to combine with their current treatment. In many cases, herbal therapy can actually help reduce the dose or duration of pharmaceutical drugs needed over time.

COMMON AILMENTS WE TREAT

Arthritis/ Weakness

Spinal Injury/IVDD/Herniated Discs

CCL/ACL

Post TPLO/ TTA/ CCL Surgery